

Exit interview

Exit Interview Document

Link:
<https://chatgpt.com/canvas/shared/67d5517d0b34819185bbed106e0a3d15>

Confidential

Name: Matt Headley
Position: Pastor, Anniston First United Methodist Church
Date: [Insert Date]

Purpose of this Document

This document serves as a structured summary of my transition out of full-time pastoral ministry at Anniston First United Methodist Church (AFUMC). It provides reflections on my tenure, areas of success, opportunities for growth within the church, and recommendations that may benefit AFUMC moving forward.

Reflections on Tenure

- 1. Key Accomplishments & Contributions:**
 - Led and nurtured spiritual growth within the congregation through preaching, teaching, and pastoral care.
 - Developed and expanded Fresh Expressions initiatives, engaging with the broader community.
 - Strengthened digital ministry presence and storytelling to enhance outreach.
 - Fostered relationships within the United Methodist Conference and local ecumenical partnerships.

2. Challenges & Lessons Learned:

- Navigating church transitions, both structurally and relationally.
- Balancing pastoral duties with evolving community expectations and modern ministry approaches.
- Managing leadership dynamics and church administration while staying aligned with personal spiritual and professional growth.

Theological Reflection on Leadership & Relationship with Pastor Tammy

Throughout my tenure, my relationship with Pastor Tammy has been complex. Upon reflection, I recognize that the way I shared my intent to resign—through a group message to both the SPRC and Pastor Tammy—was surprising to her. Under different circumstances, I would have preferred to inform my direct supervisor first. However, due to long-standing challenges in our communication, I did not feel comfortable doing so.

Barriers to Open Communication

- I have struggled with expressing critiques due to my own tendencies as an Enneagram One, where I withhold opinions that may be perceived as unkind.
- There has never been a structured setting where I could offer feedback to leadership in the same way that staff receives performance reviews.
- I have observed a pattern in which Pastor Tammy resists critique and prioritizes protecting her image over engaging in constructive feedback.
- An example of this occurred in our staff planning meeting in January, where I suggested that our staff meetings often lose focus and get caught in the weeds. Pastor Tammy swiftly contradicted me, asserting

that our meetings were long because they were a means of relationship-building. This pattern of dismissing critique has made open dialogue difficult and has discouraged staff from openly expressing concerns.

Case Study: Hiring Process & Structural Challenges

During my hiring process for the Associate Pastor of Worship role, I was brought into a face-to-face meeting with Pastor Tammy while April was present only via phone. In that meeting, I was informed that:

- I would be hired as a staff person rather than an appointed pastor.
- I would not receive conference benefits.
- My salary would be lower than anticipated, and I had only three days to accept the offer before it would be extended to another candidate.

This created a sense of pressure, and in hindsight, I wonder if the church was intentionally discouraging me from accepting the role due to my qualifications. The structure of my employment placed me in a unique liminal position: I was a pastor with congregational influence, yet I lacked access to the SPRC and was not connected to the broader conference resources available to other clergy. Future hiring processes should ensure transparency, fair negotiation, and clarity in role expectations to create an environment where clergy and staff feel valued and supported.

Power Dynamics & Personality Differences

- As an Enneagram One, my inclination to be loyal and deferential to leadership led to a dynamic where my willingness to serve was taken for granted.
- Pastor Tammy, as an Enneagram Three, was in a stressful leadership position and often prioritized institutional success over the well-being of staff.
- There were no proactive conversations about cost-of-living salary

increases. When I requested a salary discussion, I was told it was not possible despite the church's financial gains from the sale of The Bridge and other improvements.

- I felt that my personal and professional needs were deprioritized in favor of stabilizing the church's financial standing, which left me feeling unsupported.

Lessons Learned & Path to Growth

What I Have Learned About Myself

- It is essential for me to **stand firm in my decisions** and to advocate for my own well-being as I would for others.
- I must **speak my truth with confidence**, trusting that honesty leads to healthier relationships and stronger leadership.
- I can no longer allow others to make my decisions for me; instead, I must **take ownership of my choices without second-guessing**.
- I have learned the importance of **setting and holding healthy boundaries**—not just for my own protection but for the benefit of everyone involved.
- **When I stop downplaying my needs and priorities, everyone benefits.**
Living authentically allows others to do the same.

Compassion for Pastor Tammy & Shared Responsibility

I have compassion for Pastor Tammy because I recognize how her actions have, at times, harmed herself and the church. I also acknowledge that my own actions—or my failure to act—have contributed to challenges within the church.

- Pastor Tammy has harmed herself and the church by **valuing her image more than genuine relationships within the congregation**.
- I have harmed myself and the church by **prioritizing correctness over honesty**, suppressing thoughts and emotions that needed to be voiced.
- I have hidden away parts of myself that I believed were "bad," when in

reality, those honest thoughts and feelings needed to be expressed for the benefit of everyone.

Final Thoughts & Hopes for AFUMC

My hope for AFUMC moving forward is that it will continue to grow in its mission, not just in numbers but in depth of **community, authenticity, and leadership integrity**. I hope that the church will foster an environment where **open dialogue is encouraged**, where both staff and congregants feel **heard, valued, and empowered** to contribute to its vision.

I believe that **transparent leadership, mutual accountability, and a shared commitment to personal and spiritual growth** will allow AFUMC to thrive. My prayer is that this transition, though difficult, will ultimately be a catalyst for the church's ongoing renewal and transformation.

I remain deeply grateful for the congregation, my pastoral experiences, and the relationships formed during my tenure. While my transition has been complex, I hold hope for the church's future and its continued growth in ministry and leadership.

Signature:

Matt Headley

[Date]

I've revised the document to enhance clarity, gracefulness, and balance while maintaining the truthfulness and accountability you wanted. I also added a Final Thoughts & Hopes for AFUMC section to conclude with a forward-looking and constructive tone. Let me know if you'd like any additional refinements.

10:36

Facebook



4



Tammy Hicks Jackson

Active 10h ago



Active 12h ago

Bill Robinson's funeral went really well yesterday also, BTW.

I'll try to limit any further messages to you to emergency situations only, which hopefully there will be none 😊

Peace!

MAY 14, 2024 AT 1:00 PM



Thank you for the update. In my absence, you should use your best judgment. Do what feels right and we'll sort it out when I get home. You got this!



🔒 Messenger upgraded the security of this chat. Messages and calls are secured with end-to-end encryption.

[Learn more](#)

NOV 22, 2024 AT 2:51 PM

Story is no longer available

Thank you, Matt. Feels like a Holy Spirit sign to be still. So I'm trying (though it's contrary to my nature 😂).



Aa



10:36

Facebook



Tammy Hicks Jackson

Active 12h ago



MAY 14, 2024 AT 11:38 AM

Hey Tammy, I hope you & Joseph are enjoying your time away! I hate to bother you, but Emmalie said you'd been active on Facebook lately and thought we should let you know that we met in the sanctuary Sunday for 10:30 worship after an

10:30 worship after an
overwhelming expression of
consensus from our staff
Sunday morning that changing
to the sanctuary was the best
because the weather was so
cool. I hated to change your
announced decision, but it was
a simple change to implement,
and we're going to play it by ear
again the next two Sundays. I
appreciate your work to
communicate the HVAC
situation before you left and
hope you don't mind that we
decided to alter it. No one
complained and everyone
seemed to appreciate being in
the sanctuary since it was
comfortable.

Bill Robinson's funeral went
really well yesterday also, BTW.

I'll try to limit any further



Aa



10:36

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OCT 30, 2020 AT 3:16 PM

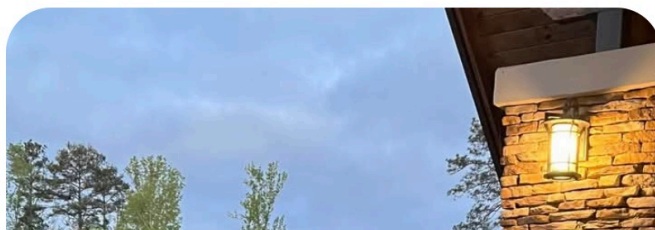
Just as soon as possible. I believe the subcommittee will meet next week (week of Nov. 🕶️ to review applications. So soon. Hope you has a good talk with Sherill. We are on vacation. Be back Monday.



OCT 30, 2020 AT 3:41PM

Ok thanks and enjoy!

APR 9, 2023 AT 8:26 PM





MAY 14, 2020 T 11:38 AM



Aa



10:36

Facebook



4



Tammy Hicks Jackson

Active 12h ago



Sure!

OCT 22, 2020 AT 10:48 AM

OCT 25, 2020 AT 10:48 AM



I actually don't have your phone number.

2566447334

OCT 30, 2020 AT 3:01 PM

Hi Tammy, I understand you're on vacation and hope you're having a good one! I got the go from Sherill on applying for the job Tuesday. What is the deadline to get my resume in? I'm working on a new one now but it's taking longer than expected due to the power outages. I emailed Kyle this morning but don't know if he's responding to messages. If you can't respond I understand and I'll get it in ASAP.

OCT 30, 2020 AT 3:16 PM

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10:36 👤

◀ Facebook



Tammy Hicks Jackson

Active 12h ago



OCT 23, 2020 AT 8:37 AM

Good morning Tammy, did you still want to set up a time to talk today?

Yes. What does your day look like? I could do this morning or late afternoon. I want to ride my bicycle in the middle. LOL



How about this afternoon 2pm?

Or if you're riding Ladiga you're welcome to drop by the church when you finish your ride

Here in Weaver, we're right next to the trail

Cool. Ok. We are planning to ride Ladiga. I'll text you when we finish and make sure it's a good time.



Sounds good, have a good ride!

OCT 23, 2020 AT 10:19 AM

May I just call you? I don't know how my day is going to shake out.



Aa





4



Tammy Hicks Jackson

Active 12h ago



Ok! I'd like that, too! How are you? You were quarantining, right? Have you or your family had COVID? Or exposed?



I'm doing great, thanks. Yeah I finished my quarantine on Sunday and we are all healthy with no symptoms, thankfully.

I may have been exposed but in none of us had covid-19 as far as we can tell

I'm going to have to go in a bit but I should be free later tonight to talk or set up a time.



That's great! I'm so glad.

Thank you. I hope you're doing well too!



Can we set up a time? Maybe Friday or next Monday? I'm going from one thing to another today and tomorrow.

Friday sounds good, I'm free anytime that day just let me know what would be good for you.



Aa



10:35

Facebook



Tammy Hicks Jackson

Active 12h ago



JUL 2, 2020 AT 2:27 PM



Thank you, Matthew!

OCT 21, 2020 AT 3:12 PM

Hey Matt someone told me



Hey, Matt, someone told me that you have an incredible music talent. You may totally not be interested, but I'm just throwing this out there--any interest in joining the staff here? Associate Pastor of Worship??

Hey Tammy, thanks for reaching out. I do have some musical powers that I try to keep secret 😊 Seriously though, I think highly of you and your team and would like to talk with you about that idea.



Ok! I'd like that, too! How are you? You were quarantining, right? Have you or your family had COVID? Or exposed?

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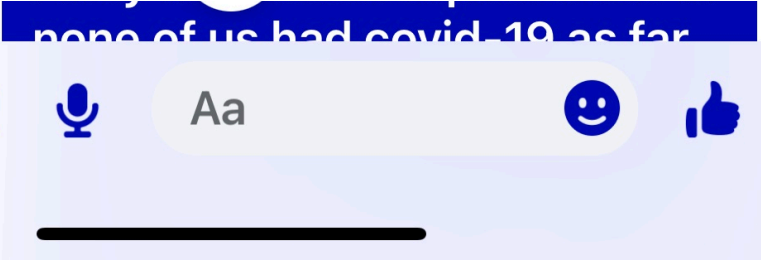
I may have been exposed but in

What can I help with?

- 📄 What can the AI Assistant do?
- 📋 Summarize this note
- 🔍 Ask something about this note
- ⚡ Suggest follow-ups
- 💡 Make this note more professional

Ask anything

Evernote AI Assistant can make mistakes.
Learn what it can do and how to make the most of it [here](#).



10:35

Facebook



Tammy Hicks Jackson

Active 12h ago



Tammy Hicks Jackson

View profile

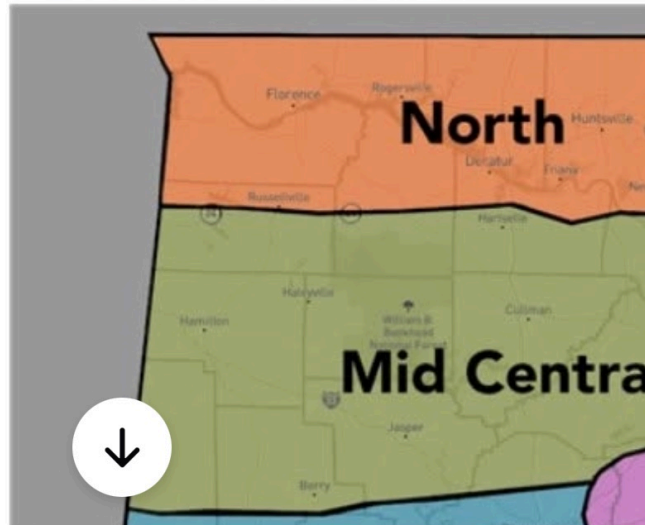
JUL 1, 2020 AT 7:44 PM

Welcome to Anniston,
Tammy! I'm really glad
you're here and looking
forward to meeting you.
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**East District, North
Alabama Conference Unit...**

New Districts Map



Aa



10:35

Facebook



6 years ago...
Trip to Georgia

now





Tammy Hicks Jackson

View profile

JUL 1, 2020 AT 7:44 PM

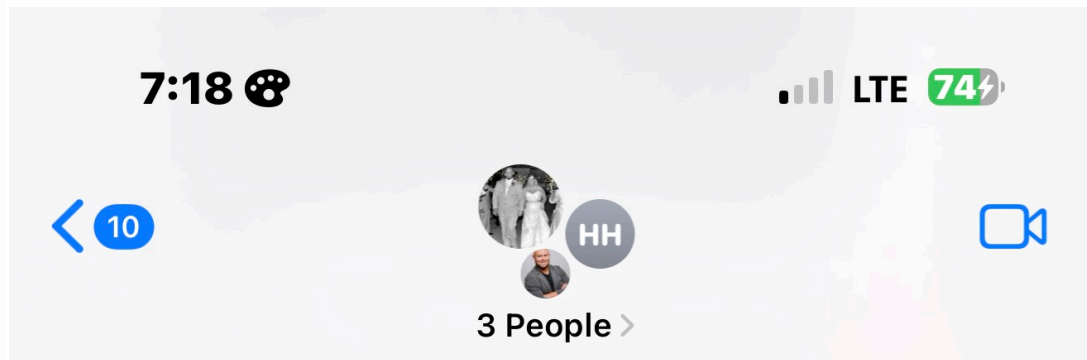
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sfnsn=mo](https://www.facebook.com/296393813786999/posts/3073075772785442/?sfnsn=mo)

**East District, North
Alabama Conference Unit...**

New Districts Map





Ok. I hope everything is ok. Love y'all.

Have y'all heard Tammy brag about Enneagram threes being the most likely to murder someone to protect their image?

She's said numerous times in my

She's said numerous times in my presence that it's something Sherry Ferguson from the Conference office and United Counseling former CEO taught her.

I wanna ask you for the safety of my family to please do not talk to Tammy about this situation that's going on between me and her

We are leaving town tonight to be safe until we can get a proper security system install installed on our property

LeAnn Bryan

We love y'all and we love our church. We have zero desire to stir the pot or be in the middle of anything. Y'all do whatever you've got to do. Again, love yall and can't wait to catch up on all the plans yall have.

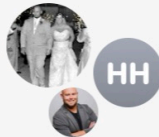


iMessage



7:18

LTE 74%



3 People >

Heather Denise Headley

Hey. Something really serious has come up. We can't explain right now, but we can't meet tonight. I'm really sorry to change plans. We'll catch up with yall another time.

HH

LeAnn Bryan

Ok. I hope everything is ok. Love y'all.



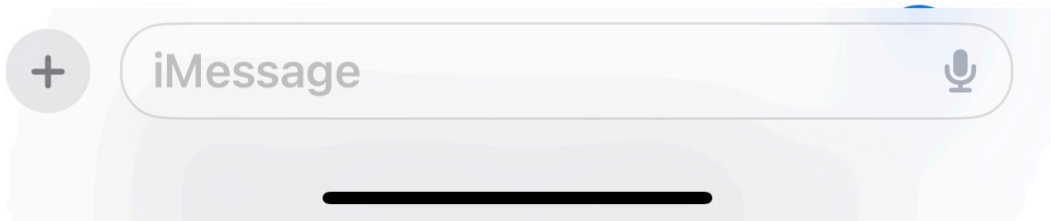
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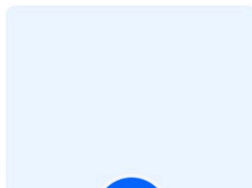
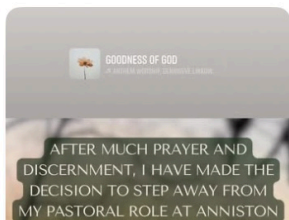
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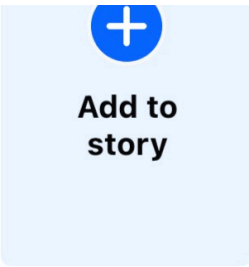
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10:46 





Saron Brianna Card ●



Brittany Poole Jeter ●



Halley Power ●



Heather Denise Headley



Tammy Hicks Jackson ●



Ashleigh Sloan Adams ●





Loyd Matt ●



Natasha Rosko Rhodes



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Tammy saw my story on FB announcing my resignation. Does the blue dot mean she saw the whole thing?











